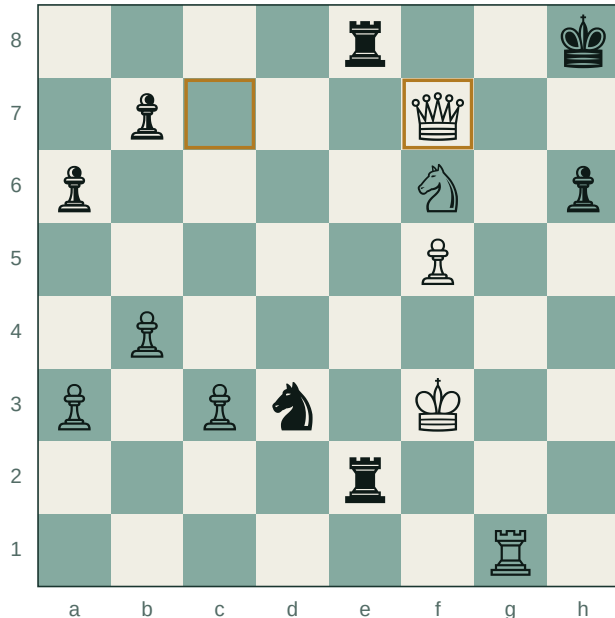


Mate in three: Black, move 36

Mate in three

Black to move



Previous move: 36.Qxf7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

36...R8e3+ 37. Kg4 Ne5+ 38. Kh5 Rh2#

36...R8e3+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **37.Kg4**.

37...Ne5+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From e5 it attacks king on g4 and queen on f7. Recorded reply: **38.Kh5**.

38...Rh2# Mate: rook on h2 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h5. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h2. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not stop at a promising check. The final mating position must still be legal after every intervening move.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Longer mating lines require accurate visualization. Track the king's square, opened lines, and every sacrificed piece through the entire sequence.

HOW TO LOOK

Work backward from a mating pattern, then calculate forward with the opponent choosing the strongest defense.

The defending king is on f3. Geometrically undefended: queen on f7 and rook on g1. Check for tactical protection.